

Haligric Research Integration Series

SPIRITISM

ESPIRITISMO — A COMPLETE DEEP DIVE

The Kardecist Tradition and the Latin American School of Joaquín Trincado

Allan Kardec · The Five Books · Reincarnation · The Perispirit
Planes of Existence · Passes · Disobsession · The Spiritist Session
Joaquín Trincado · EMECU · The Comuna Universal

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Introduction

The Philosophy That Chose Reason Over Religion and Love Over Fear

Spiritism is one of the most underappreciated sacred traditions in the Haligrlicity library — and one of the most immediately resonant with the framework's core principles. It is not widely known outside Latin America and Brazil, where it has become one of the most significant philosophical and spiritual movements in the world. It is consistently confused with Spiritualism, which is a different tradition. And within Latin America, the school of Joaquín Trincado — born in Spain, flourished in Argentina — represents the most radical and philosophically consistent expression of the Spiritist vision: a tradition that explicitly rejected fear and reward as motivations for moral living, that located the source of good and evil in the degrees of consciousness itself, and that taught that the universe operates through laws of energy that the individual participates in through their own choices across multiple lifetimes.

This document presents Spiritism in full: its origins with Allan Kardec, the Five Books that codify its doctrine, its theology and cosmology, its practices, the Latin American school of Trincado, and the Haligric lens through which it is understood in the Haligrlicity framework. It is written in honor of a grandfather who spent a lifetime teaching this tradition and who left behind a collection of Trincado's books — rare, over a century old — as a family jewel worth preserving.

In Haligrlicity, Spiritism is recognized as one of the traditions most closely aligned with the anti-fear, anti-reward moral philosophy at the heart of the framework. The Creator corrects, does not punish. Morality is pursued for one's own spiritual advancement, not because of fear or hope for external reward. The consequences of action are self-generated through universal law. This is not a comforting doctrine. It is a rigorous one — and it is the most honest account of how the moral universe actually functions.

Spiritism vs. Spiritualism — The Essential Distinction

Two Different Traditions That Share a Name Root and Almost Nothing Else

This distinction must be made clearly and first, because the two traditions are consistently confused — in popular media, in academic writing, and even within the traditions themselves.

Spiritualism — the Anglo-American tradition that emerged from the Fox sisters' "spirit rappings" in Hydesville, New York, in 1848 — is primarily a movement centered on the phenomena of spirit communication: séances, table-turning, automatic writing, and the demonstration that the dead survive and can contact the living. It has no systematic theology, no unified doctrine of reincarnation, no structured moral philosophy derived from spirit communication, and no single codifying text. It spread through the United States, Britain, and Northern Europe primarily as a religious movement offering consolation for grief and "proof" of survival after death.

Spiritism — the doctrine codified by Allan Kardec beginning in 1857 — shares the observation that intelligent communication from spirits of the dead is possible, but builds from that

starting point an entirely different structure: a systematic philosophical and moral doctrine, a specific theory of reincarnation (progressive, exclusively human-to-human, across multiple worlds), a rigorous methodology for evaluating spirit communications, a complete moral law derived from natural law rather than religious commandment, and a cosmology of multiple planes of existence and inhabited worlds. Kardec deliberately coined the French word Spiritisme to distinguish his doctrine from Spiritualisme (which in French simply means "any belief in something beyond matter").

The practical difference: Spiritualism is primarily evidential (can we prove survival?) and emotionally consolatory. Spiritism is primarily doctrinal (what does survival teach us about how to live?) and morally transformative. Trincado sharpened this to its logical extreme: Spiritism is a philosophical-rational doctrine, not a religion, not a séance practice, and not a comfort-seeking tradition. It is a school.

Note: *Spiritism is also distinct from Umbanda and Candomblé — the Afro-Brazilian traditions that incorporate spirit communication but center on orixá worship, possession ceremonies, and ritual offerings drawn from West African sacred tradition. These are covered in their own dedicated documents in the Haligricity library. Some historical conflation occurred during Brazil's 19th-century persecution of all such practices, but the doctrines are fundamentally different.*

Allan Kardec — The Codifier of Spiritism

Hippolyte Léon Denizard Rivail, 3 October 1804 – 31 March 1869

Allan Kardec was born Hippolyte Léon Denizard Rivail in Lyon, France, on 3 October 1804, into a Catholic family with a legal tradition. He was educated at the Institut Pestalozzi in Yverdon, Switzerland — a revolutionary pedagogical school founded by the educational reformer Johann Heinrich Pestalozzi, where he became a star student and eventually a teacher and collaborator. He completed a Bachelor of Arts and a doctorate, was fluent in five languages, was inducted into the Royal Academy of Arras in 1831, and organized free educational courses for the underprivileged in Paris for decades. His pedagogical books — grammars, arithmetic texts, study guides — were standard French classroom materials. He was a man of the Enlightenment: rational, systematic, committed to the idea that knowledge should be verifiable and useful.

He first heard of "turning tables" — the 1850s craze of tables moving and tipping in apparent response to questions from those seated around them — in 1854. His initial reaction was dismissal: he reportedly said he would believe it when proven that a table had a brain and nerves. But his commitment to systematic investigation overrode his skepticism, and beginning in 1855 he attended séances, rigorously tested hypotheses (fraud, hallucination, electromagnetism, unknown physical force), and concluded that the only explanation consistent with the evidence was an intelligent cause — that the communications came from spirits of the dead.

He organized thousands of questions thematically and put them to different mediums in different places, cross-checking answers for consistency. The name "Allan Kardec" — which he adopted as a pen name for all Spiritist writings — was given to him by a spirit who identified it as the name he had carried in a previous Druidic incarnation. He kept his legal name Rivail for his pedagogical works, thus maintaining a clear boundary between his two bodies of work.

Kardec died of a ruptured aortic aneurysm on 31 March 1869, at the moment he was signing papers for a new, larger headquarters for the Spiritist Society. He is buried at Père Lachaise Cemetery in Paris, where his grave — designed by his wife Amélie Boudet Rivail — bears the inscription: "To be born, to die, to be reborn again, and to progress unceasingly — such is the law." Thousands of visitors continue to leave flowers at the grave to this day.

The Five Books of the Spiritist Codification

The Pentateuch of Spiritism — 1857 to 1868

The five books Kardec produced between 1857 and 1868 constitute what Spiritists call the Codification — the complete, systematic statement of the doctrine. Kardec insisted that no single communication or medium was sufficient authority; only teachings that recurred independently across multiple mediums in multiple places and that satisfied rational scrutiny were accepted into the Codification. The five books are:

The Spirits' Book (Le Livre des Esprits, 18 April 1857)

The foundational philosophical text — the document that launched the movement. In its expanded 1860 edition it contains 1,019 questions organized in four books, answered by spirits (primarily a spirit who identified itself as "the Spirit of Truth"). The four books cover: the primary causes (God, the elements of the universe, creation); the spirit world (spirits, the incarnation, the return to spirit life, plurality of existences); moral laws (divine law, the law of work, of reproduction, of preservation, of destruction, of society, of progress, of equality, of liberty, of justice, love and charity, moral perfection); and hopes and consolations (earthly pains and joys, future pains and joys, progress of humanity). This is the book from which every subsequent Spiritist teaching flows.

The Mediums' Book (1861)

The experimental and practical guide to spirit communication. Covers the theory of all types of manifestations (physical and intellectual), the means of communication with spirits, the development of mediumship, the dangers and pitfalls of mediumship (including the risk of self-delusion and the influence of inferior spirits), and the evocation of spirits. Where The Spirits' Book asks what spirits teach, The Mediums' Book asks how communication occurs and how to evaluate it critically.

The Gospel According to Spiritism (1864)

The moral and devotional work — the most widely read and studied book in Spiritist centers worldwide. Kardec extracts moral maxims from the canonical Gospels (focused on Christ's ethical teachings rather than his theology) and shows their alignment with Spiritist doctrine. Contains the axiom that defines Spiritist ethics: "Outside of charity there is no salvation." This book is used as the basis for the opening reading in most Spiritist sessions. It also addresses beatitudes, the purpose of suffering, the nature of true prayer, and the relationship between Spiritism and Christianity.

Heaven and Hell (Le Ciel et l'Enfer, 1865)

The book on divine justice. Kardec systematically critiques the Catholic doctrines of eternal punishment, hell, purgatory, and limbo — showing them to be incompatible with the idea of a just and loving God. He presents instead the Spiritist understanding: that post-mortem states are varied, progressive, and self-generated by the spirit's own moral condition; that there is no eternal damnation (only temporary states of suffering that the spirit works through and eventually transcends); and that the "hell" described in religious traditions is a distorted representation of the real states of inferior spirits. Includes case examples of spirits describing their post-mortem conditions.

The Genesis (1868)

The scientific work — the last book Kardec completed before his death. Addresses the reconciliation of Spiritism with natural law, showing that spirit phenomena are natural phenomena operating through as-yet-incompletely-understood laws, not violations of the natural order. Critiques the miraculous as a category: in Spiritism, what religion calls "miracles" are simply natural laws incompletely understood. Also covers the formation of the universe, the plurality of inhabited worlds, and the law of causes and effects as the governing principle of moral life. This book establishes Spiritism's claim to be not anti-science but an extension of the scientific project into the domain of the spirit.

Complementary works by Kardec include *What is Spiritism?* (a brief introductory text), *Spiritism in its Simplest Expression* (a condensed summary), and his journal *La Revue Spirite*, which he founded on 1 January 1858 and edited until his death. He also founded the *Société Parisienne des Études Spiritiques* (Parisian Society of Spiritist Studies) in 1858.

Philosophical and Historical Roots

Mesmer, Swedenborg, the Enlightenment, and the Positivist Method

Spiritism did not emerge in a vacuum. Its intellectual genealogy runs through several 18th and 19th century currents that shaped its vocabulary, method, and cosmological assumptions.

Franz Anton Mesmer (1734-1815) — Animal Magnetism

Mesmer's theory of animal magnetism — a universal invisible fluid that flows through all living beings and can be directed by trained practitioners for healing — is the direct ancestor of Spiritism's fluidic language, the concept of the perispirit, and the healing practice of the pass. Mesmer's disciples (particularly Armand-Marie Jacques de Chastenet, Marquis de Puységur, and Joseph Philippe François Deleuze) developed "magnetic somnambulism" — a trance state in which subjects exhibited clairvoyance, healing ability, and apparent communication with absent persons. This tradition flowed directly into the séance movements of the 1840s and 1850s and is the source of Kardec's energetic language.

Emanuel Swedenborg (1688-1772) — Visionary Cosmology

The Swedish scientist and mystic who described detailed accounts of conversations with spirits of other worlds, the structure of heaven and hell as states of consciousness rather than places, and the correspondence between spiritual and natural realities — providing the cosmological template that both Spiritualism and Spiritism drew on. His influence is most

visible in Kardec's treatment of the multiplicity of inhabited worlds and the graduated spiritual states of post-mortem existence.

Enlightenment Rationalism

Kardec's methodology — systematic observation, cross-examination, rejection of testimony that cannot be corroborated, submission of everything to reason — is profoundly shaped by Enlightenment epistemology. His insistence that "faith that cannot meet reason is not unshakeable faith" is one of the most important statements in the entire Spiritist tradition. He explicitly rejected dogma, demanded that spirit communications be evaluated by their moral quality and internal consistency rather than accepted on authority, and framed Spiritism as an extension of the scientific method into a domain science had not yet reached.

Positivism

Auguste Comte's positivism — the dominant philosophical current in France during Kardec's active period — shaped his empirical approach even as he rejected its materialist conclusion (that consciousness is entirely a product of physical processes). Kardec agreed that knowledge must be grounded in observation and experience; he disagreed that the only valid observations were physical ones. Spiritism is, in this sense, a critique of positivism from within the positivist framework.

Spiritism in Brazil and Latin America

How a French Doctrine Became the Defining Spiritual Movement of Brazil

Brazil is today the country with the largest number of Spiritists in the world — 3.8 million self-identified Spiritists in the 2010 IBGE (national statistics) Census (2.0% of the population), up 65% from 2.3 million in 2000, with the Brazilian Spiritist Federation estimating up to 30 million regular sympathizers. This is not an accident but the result of a century and a half of remarkably effective doctrinal, charitable, and cultural work by the Brazilian Spiritist movement.

Spiritism entered Brazil through French-educated elites in the late 1850s and 1860s. The Federação Espírita Brasileira (Brazilian Spiritist Federation, FEB) was founded on 1 January 1884. Brazil's 1890 Penal Code criminalized Spiritism and the practice of medicine by non-physicians (targeting Spiritist healing) — up to six months' imprisonment. The practice only ceased to be officially prohibited with the 1940 Penal Code reform. Despite persecution, the movement grew continuously.

Two figures were decisive for Brazilian Spiritism's popular embrace. Dr. Adolfo Bezerra de Menezes (1831–1900) — sometimes called "the Brazilian Kardec" — consolidated the charitable and healing dimensions of the movement and served as FEB president from 1895 until his death. Francisco "Chico" Xavier (1910–2002) was the most prolific psychographic medium in history: he produced over 400 books dictated by spirits (including the spirit of Kardec himself, according to Brazilian Spiritists), selling more than 25 million copies, with all royalties donated to charity. He was voted "Greatest Brazilian of All Time" in a 2012 national poll. The International Spiritist Council (founded 28 November 1992 in Madrid) represents Spiritism in 36 countries with over 13 million followers worldwide.

A significant internal controversy: the FEB came under the influence of Jean-Baptiste Roustaing's Four Gospels, which claimed that Christ had only a spiritual body (not a physical one) — a teaching "purist" Kardecists reject as a mystical deviation from Kardec's rational method. The tension between the FEB's more religious orientation and the "pure Kardecism" of other groups remains active.

Core Beliefs — God, the Soul, and Future Life

The Three Pillars of the Spiritist Doctrine

Kardec organized Spiritism around three foundational affirmations: the existence of God, the immortal soul (spirit), and future life through reincarnation and moral progress. These are not articles of faith in the religious sense — they are conclusions drawn from the evidence of spirit communication, evaluated by reason and moral consistency.

God in Spiritism

God is defined in The Spirits' Book as "the Supreme Intelligence, first cause of all things." The attributes: eternal, immutable, immaterial, unique, all-powerful, sovereignly just and good. This is explicitly not an anthropomorphic figure — not a personal father in the theological sense, not a ruler who issues commands, not a judge who sentences souls. God is the primary cause and the author of the natural laws that govern both the physical and moral dimensions of reality. God does not intervene arbitrarily in individual lives; the laws God established operate consistently and without exception.

Crucially for the Haligric alignment: God does not punish. Suffering is not divine punishment but the self-generated consequence of choices made under the law of cause and effect. Trincado made this the centerpiece of his teaching: "The Creator does not punish — He corrects." This single formulation dissolves the entire fear-based moral framework that underlies most religious systems and replaces it with a law-based understanding in which every consequence is natural, educational, and ultimately purposeful.

The Soul / Spirit

In Spiritism, "soul" and "spirit" are used somewhat interchangeably for the immortal, individual principle that survives physical death and reincarnates. All spirits are created simple and ignorant, equal in their origin, and endowed with free will. The spirit is the responsible agent — not the body (which is a temporary vehicle) and not the "soul" in the more passive religious sense. The spirit carries its character, its memories, and its moral accumulations across incarnations.

The Nature of Spirits and the Spirit Hierarchy

From Imperfect to Pure — The Scale of Spiritual Evolution

Spirits in Kardec's system are not angels and demons as separate created orders — they are all the same kind of being at different stages of evolution. There are no inherently evil spirits; there are only spirits in earlier stages of development who have not yet transcended the

inferior passions. This is one of the most important theological positions in Spiritism: evil is not a permanent metaphysical force but a temporary condition of incomplete evolution.

The three broad orders of spirits: Pure Spirits — those who have attained maximum moral and intellectual perfection; they have no more need of reincarnation. Good Spirits (spirits of progress) — those whose dominant desire is goodness, who act as guides and protectors for less-evolved spirits. Imperfect Spirits — those who are ignorant, prone to error and inferior passions, who have not yet developed the moral sense to recognize and resist harmful impulses.

Spirits never regress. They may stagnate in lower states for long periods, but the movement of evolution is always eventually upward. The time scale is vast — the process of reaching perfection may span many thousands of incarnations across many worlds. But the direction is fixed and the destination is the same for all.

Between incarnations, spirits exist in the spirit world in a state that reflects their moral development. Highly evolved spirits inhabit luminous, joyful spiritual states; inferior spirits remain in states of relative darkness and suffering — not because God has sentenced them there but because their own moral condition creates that experience. This is Spiritism's answer to the question of heaven and hell: both are real as states of consciousness, neither is eternal, and both are self-generated.

The Perispirit — The Fluidic Body

The Semi-Material Link Between Spirit and Body

The perispirit (periespírito) is one of Spiritism's most distinctive and practically significant concepts. It is a "semi-material," fluidic body — neither purely spiritual nor purely physical — that links the immaterial spirit to the physical body during incarnation and accompanies the spirit between lives. A human being is the union of three elements: the body (material, mortal), the spirit (immaterial, immortal), and the perispirit (semi-material, fluidic).

The perispirit is the vehicle through which thoughts and emotions produce effects in the physical world, through which healing energies operate, and through which the spirit gradually becomes aware of and responds to the material environment. It carries the imprint of the spirit's moral and emotional history — functioning as a record of accumulated experience. It is also the vehicle on which the pass operates: healing in Spiritism acts first on the perispirit, which then influences the physical body.

The concept derives from Mesmer's universal magnetic fluid, reframed spiritually: the perispirit is the individualized portion of that universal fluid that has organized around a specific spirit. In healthy individuals the perispirit is in equilibrium; in illness or under negative spiritual influence, the perispirit is disturbed, and that disturbance eventually manifests in the physical body.

Reincarnation in Spiritism

Progressive, Human-to-Human, Across Multiple Worlds

Spiritist reincarnation is categorically different from Hindu metempsychosis (transmigration of souls) and must not be confused with it. The specific Spiritist understanding: reincarnation is exclusively human-to-human — spirits do not incarnate as animals (Kardec explicitly rejected metempsychosis on grounds of rational consistency). Reincarnation is progressive and never regressive — a spirit who has reached a given level of development does not fall back to a previous level. Reincarnation may occur on multiple inhabited worlds at different stages of evolution.

Why reincarnation? In Spiritism it is not punishment but the mechanism of evolution. Each incarnation provides a specific set of experiences, challenges, and relationships through which the spirit develops specific qualities it lacked. The body, the family, the historical moment, and the life circumstances are all chosen (by the spirit with guidance from more advanced spirits) for the educational value they provide. Memory of past lives is normally veiled because carrying full memory of all previous lives would make functioning in the current life impossible.

Higher spirits reincarnate voluntarily, choosing to return to less-evolved worlds on missions of assistance. Imperfect spirits reincarnate compulsorily — they must continue to experience the consequences of their choices until they develop sufficient moral clarity to choose differently. There is no divine sentence; there is only the logic of evolution. The spirit itself, through its choices, determines the conditions of its next incarnation.

Planes of Existence and the Plurality of Worlds

Multiple Inhabited Worlds, Multiple States of Spirit Life

One of Kardec's most original contributions was his systematic development of the plurality of inhabited worlds — the idea that Earth is one of many worlds inhabited by intelligent beings at different stages of evolution. This was not an eccentric speculation but a reasoned position supported by both the testimony of spirits and the astronomical knowledge of his era (Camille Flammarion, the pioneering astronomer, was a Spiritist and developed this cosmology further).

Earth, in Kardec's cosmology, is a "world of atonement and trials" — one of the less-evolved inhabited worlds, where spirits who have not yet developed sufficient moral consciousness come to experience the specific challenges of dense material existence. Less-advanced spirits inhabit heavier, more material worlds; as they purify through reincarnation and moral development, they progress to inhabit less material, more luminous worlds. The most advanced spirits inhabit worlds that are barely material at all.

The material and spiritual planes are not separate universes but overlapping dimensions of the same reality. The spirit world interpenetrates the material world; the incarnate and discarnate states are two modes of the same existence, not two separate domains. Death is not a transition from one place to another but a transition from one state of consciousness to another within the same continuous universe.

Trincado elaborated this into a more explicit energy-based cosmology: "All is Spiritual Magnetism. The Universe is the homeland of incarnate and discarnate spirits simultaneously." For Trincado the distinction between material and spiritual planes was ultimately one of

degree within a single energetic continuum — a position that resonates with both the Hermetic "as above, so below" and the Haligric principle that the universe is never external.

The Moral Law — Anti-Fear, Anti-Reward

Why Spiritism's Ethics Is the Most Honest Account of How the Moral Universe Works

The moral law in Spiritism is the natural law — inscribed in the conscience, knowable by reason, and operating through the same consistency as physical natural laws. It is not a set of commandments issued by an external authority and enforced by threat of punishment or promise of reward. It is simply how reality works.

The engine of moral reality in Spiritism is the law of cause and effect — every action produces consequences that the spirit experiences sooner or later, in this life or in subsequent lives. These consequences are not imposed by God as punishment; they are the natural and necessary results of the action itself, operating through the same logic as physical causality. A spirit who acts with cruelty creates a specific kind of experience for itself; a spirit who acts with love creates a different kind of experience. The moral law is not separate from physical law — it is the extension of the same principle into the domain of consciousness.

The revolutionary moral implication: goodness should be pursued not because God will reward it and evil avoided not because God will punish it, but because they are the conditions of the spirit's own development and the creators of the spirit's own experience. The person who does good out of fear of hell is not yet at the level where goodness is genuine. The person who does good because it is what their own nature requires and what their own evolution demands is operating at the level Spiritism considers spiritually mature.

Trincado articulated this most clearly: "Whoever does good out of fear or with the hope of reward does not do good — they do business." This single sentence captures the entire Spiritist moral philosophy. The goal is to reach the level at which goodness is not a transaction but an expression of what one is. That level is reached through the long process of reincarnation and moral development — not through a single conversion experience or a moment of divine grace.

The Creator does not punish — He corrects. All suffering is educational. All consequences are self-generated. Goodness is its own purpose and its own reward. This is not a comforting theology. It is a true one. — Joaquín Trincado, paraphrased from El Espiritismo en su Asiento (1919)

Good and Evil in Spiritism

Not External Forces — Degrees of a Spirit's Own Evolution

In Spiritism, good and evil are not metaphysical forces in opposition — they are the two poles of a single scale of consciousness. An evolved spirit acts with wisdom and love because it has developed the moral clarity to do so. An inferior spirit acts with selfishness, cruelty, or ignorance because it has not yet developed the moral clarity to act otherwise. The difference is not kind but degree — both are the same kind of being at different stages of the same journey.

This has a specific and important practical implication: negative spiritual influence (what Spiritism calls obsession) is not demonic possession in the theological sense but the influence of inferior spirits — spirits who, by reason of their evolutionary state, are attached to lower vibrations and who may deliberately or involuntarily disturb the harmony of incarnate spirits whose own vibrations are compatible with theirs. The solution is not exorcism (which implies a battle against an external enemy) but education and moral elevation — for both the obsessed person and the obsessing spirit.

Trincado's specific contribution here was to frame this energetically: good energies and bad energies are real and operate through the universal magnetic fluid. A person's moral and emotional state creates a specific energetic field; that field attracts spirits of a compatible vibration. This is not metaphor — it is, in Trincado's view, the precise mechanism of spiritual influence. Elevate the energy and you change the company you keep, on both sides of the veil.

Mediumship and Spirit Communication

The Purpose, the Types, and the Critical Method

Spirit communication in Spiritism is not entertainment, fortune-telling, or séance spectacle. Its purpose is instruction, moral improvement, and consolation — to provide evidence of survival after death, to transmit moral teachings from advanced spirits, and to assist both incarnate and discarnate beings in their development.

Kardec enumerated many types of mediums in *The Mediums' Book*, divided into two main classes. Mediums for physical effects produce observable physical phenomena: table movements, sounds, levitation, apports. Mediums for intellectual effects transmit communications: psychographic mediums (through automatic writing — the most common and important type in Brazilian Spiritism), speaking mediums (who speak while in trance or semi-trance), seeing mediums (clairvoyants), hearing mediums (clairaudients), and intuitive or inspired mediums (who receive impressions and translate them through their own faculties).

The critical method is essential. Kardec insisted that no communication should be accepted simply because it comes from a spirit. Spirits vary as much in their knowledge, truthfulness, and moral development as people do. The criteria for evaluating a communication: its moral quality (does it counsel goodness without ulterior motive?), its consistency with verified knowledge, and its concordance with communications from other independent sources on the same topic. Spirits who demand blind belief, flatter the medium, or counsel actions that contradict reason and morality are to be distrusted regardless of the spectacular nature of the phenomena they produce.

Psychography — the practice of writing as a vehicle for spirit communication — became the dominant form of mediumship in Brazilian Spiritism, producing not just individual messages but complete books attributed to the spirits of deceased writers, scientists, and historical figures. Chico Xavier's 400-plus psychographed books, produced over seven decades, remain the most prolific and culturally significant body of psychographic work in the tradition.

Universal Fluid and Energy Theory

The Connecting Medium Between All Planes of Existence

Spiritism posits a universal fluid that permeates all planes of existence — material and spiritual — and serves as the medium through which spiritual energies operate in the physical world. This concept descends directly from Mesmer's animal magnetism and was elaborated by Kardec as the foundation of his understanding of spirit phenomena, healing, and the perispirit.

Thoughts and emotions are understood in Spiritism as real forces that imprint on this universal fluid and produce real effects — attracting compatible spirits, affecting the health of the perispirit and body, and contributing to the moral atmosphere of a place or community. This is not metaphor: it is the mechanism through which prayer works, through which the pass operates, through which fluidified water carries healing properties, and through which the moral quality of a Spiritist center's participants determines the quality of the spirits attracted to it.

Trincado's synthesis was his most radical: he reduced the entire cosmology to "All is Spiritual Magnetism." Matter is dense spiritual energy; spirit is refined matter; the two are not separate substances but the same substance at different degrees of refinement. This proto-energetic monism places Trincado's system in close alignment with modern energy theories and with the Haligric principle that the universe is never external — all is the same substance, the same energy, the same consciousness, operating at different frequencies.

Joaquín Trincado and the EMECU

19 August 1866, Cintruénigo, Navarra – 6 December 1935, Buenos Aires

Joaquín Trincado Mateo was born on 19 August 1866 in Cintruénigo, a small town in the Navarra region of Spain, to working-class parents — Ignacio Trincado Alfaro and Romualda Mateo de Ayala. He received brief Jesuit schooling before becoming a self-taught electrician, a trade that gave him both a practical understanding of energy and a healthy skepticism toward institutional religious authority. He emigrated to Argentina in 1903, married Mercedes Riglos Cosis, and had three children.

In 1909 he encountered Spiritism at the "Constancia" society — Argentina's oldest Spiritist group, founded in 1877. He was drawn to the doctrine but repelled by what he saw as its dogmatic and religious deviations from Kardec's rational foundation: the mixing of Spiritism with saints, miracles, healings-for-payment, and institutional religiosity. He broke away and began holding his own sessions in his home, working with a small group of mediums including Mariana Palacios (speaking medium), Pedro Portillo (possession medium), and José González (seer).

He founded the Escuela Magnético-Espiritual de la Comuna Universal (Magnetic-Spiritual School of the Universal Commune, EMECU) in Buenos Aires on 20 September 1911, naming his specific expression of the doctrine "Espiritismo Luz y Verdad" (Spiritism, Light and Truth). In the twenty-four years he led it, the EMECU established 183 branches (called cátedras or aulas — "chairs" or "classrooms," consistent with his framing of the movement as a school rather than a church) across Argentina, Spain, Cuba, Mexico, Guatemala, Nicaragua, El Salvador, Honduras, Puerto Rico, Santo Domingo, Uruguay, Venezuela, and the United States. He died of pulmonary and cardiac disease on 6 December 1935 in Buenos Aires.

Trincado's Core Teachings and Divergences from Kardec

Where Trincado Agreed, Where He Diverged, and What He Added

Trincado accepted Kardec's five fundamental postulates: the existence of God, the pre-existence and survival of the spirit, reincarnation, communication of spirits, and the plurality of inhabited worlds. On these foundations he built a system that diverged from Kardecism in character, emphasis, and social application.

Pure Philosophical Rationalism — No Religion

Where Kardec kept a "religious" dimension and drew heavily on Christian moral framing (particularly Christ's ethics), Trincado stripped away all religiosity. EMECU explicitly does not use prayer in the devotional sense, does not maintain religious icons or rituals, and rejects the mixing of Spiritism with any religious tradition. His system is presented as a purely philosophical-rational doctrine knowable through reason alone. The school "exposes, does not impose" — students are invited to reason through the teachings, not to accept them on faith.

God as E.L.O.I. — The Creator

Trincado refers to God/the Creator using the term E.L.O.I. — presented as one of the names by which the creative principle is known, derived from the Aramaic Eloï (used in the Gospel accounts of the crucifixion). In his cosmology, Eloï is not a person but the principle of creative love-intelligence from which all reality flows. His proclamation: "The Universe in solidarity. The whole World communized. The Law is one — the Substance is one. One is the beginning — one is the end. All is Spiritual Magnetism."

The Law of Justice and Love as Supreme Axis

Kardec's moral decalogue placed the Law of Love as the last and highest — the synthesis of all other moral laws. Trincado elevated this to the governing principle of the entire system and insisted that the Law of Justice and Love is sufficient to deduce all moral conclusions without reference to religious tradition. "Love your neighbor as yourself" is not a religious commandment in Trincado's system but a statement of how the universal energy operates: love circulates, returns to its source, and elevates all it passes through.

Anti-Clerical, Anti-Institutional Discourse

Trincado's anti-clericalism was fierce and explicit — directed not only at the Catholic Church (which had historically persecuted Spiritism throughout Latin America) but at all institutional religious authority. He argued that institutional religion maintains its power through the fear-and-reward system: obey or be punished, comply or be excluded. The EMECU's entire moral structure is constructed as the antithesis of this: no threats, no promises of external reward, no intermediaries between the individual and the universal law.

The Claimed Essene Lineage

Trincado claimed that EMECU continues the Essene school founded by Moses, whose secrets were numbered 1 to 14 in geometric figures (the "Kábala Secreta"). He described a journey to "the Orient of Jerusalem" in 1912 where Essene guardians commissioned him to open the

school. This is a hagiographic claim made by the movement about its own founder; it is not independently verifiable and should be understood as part of the tradition's self-presentation rather than as historical fact.

The "Fourteen Economies" and the Table of Values

Trincado described spiritual evolution through a "table of values with infinite degrees" advanced through what he called "fourteen economies" — stages or qualities of spiritual development. The specifics of this system are elaborated in his books and constitute one of the more distinctive technical elements of trincadista doctrine not found in Kardec.

The Comuna Universal — Spiritism and Social Reform

The Radical Political Dimension of Trincado's Vision

One of the most distinctive and least discussed elements of Trincado's system is its fusion of Spiritist doctrine with a comprehensive program of social transformation. The "Universal Commune" is not a metaphor for spiritual community but a literal political and economic proposal: the gradual, non-violent transformation of human society toward the abolition of private property, national borders, social classes, and war, and the establishment of a universal human family governed by the Law of Justice and Love.

Trincado distinguished his "Universal Commune" sharply from Marxist communism — which he saw as materialist, atheist, and prone to violence. His communalism was grounded in the spiritual principle that all human beings are evolving spirits of equal origin and equal dignity, and that the social structures that create inequality and conflict are spiritually unjust not merely politically inconvenient. "Violence engenders violence; love bears the fruit of love."

He gave this vision practical expression through the founding of communal colonies: Los Libertadores, Los Franciscos, and Colonia Jaime (founded 25 July 1932) — communities in Argentina designed to embody the principles of collective sharing and mutual support. He also supported Puerto Rican independence and praised Augusto Sandino's resistance in Nicaragua, situating EMECU within the broader current of Latin American anti-colonial and social-reform politics of the 1920s and 1930s.

He also founded two organizations parallel to the EMECU: the Unión Hispano-Américo-Oceánica (UHAO, 1921) — a pan-Latin American cultural and philosophical union — and the Unión Femenina (Women's Union), reflecting his commitment to gender equality within the movement.

Major Works of Joaquín Trincado

The Books That Constitute the Trincadista Corpus

According to peer-reviewed scholarship (Alejandra G. Galicia Martínez, REHMLAC+ 2024, drawing on Diego Moraes, *Maestros del esoterismo en el Río de la Plata*, 2016), Trincado's corpus comprises 46 books in total, with approximately 14 published in his lifetime. EMECU's own materials give somewhat different figures (18 of 40) — the discrepancy reflects both the

complexity of his unpublished manuscripts and the variation between the Buenos Aires central chair and regional chairs' catalogues.

Major published titles include:

Buscando a Dios y asiento del Dios Amor (written 1909-1911)

The foundational work, written during the founding period of EMECU. Establishes the search for the Creator as the starting point and the Love of God as the axis of all doctrine.

El Magnetismo en su origen o Método Supremo (1916-1919)

The core technical work on energy and magnetism — Trincado's elaboration of the fluidic theory as the foundation of all Spiritist practice.

El Espiritismo en su Asiento (1919)

The primary doctrinal statement — a comprehensive explanation of Trincado's specific version of Spiritism, its differences from Kardec, and its philosophical foundations.

Filosofía Austera Racional (1920)

The philosophical work — Trincado's systematic statement of the rational-philosophical basis of his doctrine, explicitly contrasted with religious and mystical approaches.

El Espiritismo Estudiado o Política del Creador (1922)

An analysis of Spiritism's social and political implications — the "politics of the Creator," meaning the governing principles that derive from universal law.

Los Cinco Amores (1922)

One of his most widely read works — a pedagogical framework for the five "loves" or modes of relationship through which the spirit develops.

Conócete a ti mismo (1924)

The self-knowledge work — drawing on the Socratic maxim and developing it within the Spiritist framework of soul evolution.

Alfaquí Vademécum (1924)

A practical guide to the school's teaching methods and doctrinal study.

Los Extremos se Toca (1929)

A philosophical work on the relationship between apparent opposites — matter and spirit, good and evil, individual and universal.

Código de Amor Universal (1934)

His final major published work — a code of universal love as both philosophical principle and practical guide.

Filosofía Enciclopédica Universal (multiple volumes)

The encyclopedic work — a multi-volume philosophical synthesis covering the full range of trincadista doctrine.

Note: The term "*Biblioteca Cractos*" that sometimes appears in references to Trincado's corpus could not be verified in any authoritative source. All reliable references — academic, institutional (EMECU), and primary — use "*la Biblioteca de la Escuela*," "*la obra del Maestro Joaquín Trincado*," or simply "*el corpus trincadista*." If your family collection uses this term, it may be a proprietary label used within a specific

regional branch or a variant spelling of a term from one of Trincado's less-documented works. It should not be treated as an established or universal designation without a specific primary source.

The EMECU After Trincado

Continuity, Leadership, and the Living Movement

Trincado died on 6 December 1935. Leadership of the EMECU passed first to his widow, Mercedes Riglos Cosis de Trincado, then to his son Juan Donato Trincado Riglos (who died in 1992), and currently to Víctor Rolando Trincado, who holds the title of "Maestro Nato" and Director General. The movement continues active in Argentina, Mexico, Venezuela, Cuba, Nicaragua, Guatemala, Puerto Rico, and elsewhere in Latin America.

A significant rupture occurred in 1938, when the Mexican Regional Chair split from the Buenos Aires central chair over organizational and doctrinal disagreements. The two branches continue to operate in parallel, each claiming continuity with Trincado's founding vision. This is a common dynamic in movements built around a charismatic founding figure; it does not negate either tradition's connection to Trincado's actual writings.

The movement's survival for nearly a century after its founder's death — without the institutional support of a major national federation, without the media penetration of Chico Xavier's Brazilian Spiritism, and without the academic recognition that Kardecism has received — is itself evidence of the depth of commitment the trincadista tradition generates in its adherents.

The Spiritist Session — Step-by-Step

The Structure of a Typical Spiritist Meeting

The Spiritist session (*sessão espírita* in Brazil, *reunión espiritista* in Spanish-speaking countries) is the central collective practice of Spiritism. It is held in a Spiritist center, society, or association — never called a church. The room is clean, simply furnished, and quiet. The session does not require special clothing, ritual objects, candles, or incense — Spiritism explicitly rejects the theatrical trappings of religious ceremony.

Step 1 — Arrival and Harmonization

Participants arrive and settle into a calm, introspective state. The room's atmosphere — the collective moral and mental vibration of those present — is understood to determine the quality of the spirits that attend. This is why Spiritist centers are careful about who participates: a person in a state of agitation, anger, or negative intent disturbs the vibratory field.

Step 2 — Opening Prayer

A collective prayer — read aloud or recited from memory — invokes the presence of good spirits, asks for light, love, peace, and protection, and states the intention of the gathering. In Spiritism, prayer is not petition to change God's will but a means of moral and energetic alignment: the mind turned consciously toward goodness attracts good spirits and creates the conditions for beneficial work.

Step 3 — Reading and Lecture (Palestra)

A passage is read from Kardec's works (most commonly *The Gospel According to Spiritism*) or from another morally instructive text, followed by an educational talk on doctrine or ethics. This doctrinal grounding is not optional — Spiritism insists that understanding the reasons behind practice is as important as the practice itself.

Step 4 — Mediumistic Work

Depending on the session type: mediums may produce psychographic communications, incorporated messages, or clairvoyant impressions. Mediums in training receive supervision. In disobsession sessions, the mediums work specifically with inferior spirits in need of help. All mediumistic work is understood as service — to the incarnate and discarnate participants alike.

Step 5 — Passes and Fluidic Therapy

After or during the session, trained workers offer passes to those present. Fluidified water may be distributed. These are offered freely — never for payment, which would transform a spiritual service into a commercial transaction.

Step 6 — Closing Prayer

Thanks are offered to the spirit benefactors and to God. The energetic field opened by the session is consciously closed. Participants return to ordinary consciousness gradually.

Step 7 — Charity Follow-Up

Many centers maintain charitable programs (food distribution, education, healthcare support) that are understood as inseparable from the doctrinal work. Spiritism holds that charity is the supreme practical expression of the doctrine.

Passes — Fluidic Healing — Step-by-Step

The Healing Practice of Brazilian Spiritism

The pass (*passe espírita*) is the signature healing practice of Brazilian Spiritism — a form of laying-on of hands in which the pass-giver (*passista*) acts as a channel for both magnetic and spiritual energies directed at rebalancing the recipient's perispirit. Unlike the similar practices in other traditions, the pass is understood in Spiritism to involve the active participation of spirit benefactors — not merely the *passista*'s own energy.

Step 1 — Preparation

The *passista* prepares through prayer and intentional moral attunement — placing themselves in a state of genuine desire to help rather than personal performance. The quality of the *passista*'s own spiritual state directly affects the quality of the pass.

Step 2 — The Recipient Settles

The recipient sits quietly with eyes closed, in a receptive, calm state. Both *passista* and recipient are encouraged to maintain an attitude of faith — not in the sense of belief without evidence but in the sense of genuine openness to the possibility of help.

Step 3 — The Movement of the Hands

The *passista* raises and moves their hands over the recipient's body — typically without touching, though light touch is used by some practitioners. The hand movements follow

the energy field of the perispirit rather than the physical body's surface. Movements may be specific (addressing particular areas of disturbance) or general (a full-body sweep).

Step 4 — The Energetic Transfer

Spirit benefactors withdraw energies from the passista's perispirit (if magnetic pass) or channel their own spiritual energies through the passista (if spiritual pass), directing beneficial fluids into areas where the recipient's perispirit is disturbed or depleted. The passista is the channel; the healing is understood to come ultimately from the spirit benefactors.

Step 5 — The Duration

A pass typically lasts two to five minutes per person. Longer is not necessarily better; the quality of attunement matters more than the duration.

Step 6 — The Closing

The passista makes a closing gesture — often a sweeping movement away from the recipient — to complete the energy transaction and separate the fields.

Note: *The pass addresses the perispirit; it does not replace medical treatment. Brazilian Spiritism has always maintained that spirit healing is complementary to conventional medicine, not a substitute for it. Spiritist hospitals and clinics integrate both approaches.*

Fluidified Water

Water as a Vehicle of Beneficial Spiritual Energy

Fluidified (or magnetized) water is a complementary healing element widely used in Brazilian Spiritism. Plain water is placed near mediums or passistas during the session, and good spirits are asked to charge it with beneficial energies. The water is then distributed to session participants — typically to drink, but also sometimes to wash affected body parts externally.

The theoretical basis: water, as a substance with a particularly receptive molecular structure, is understood to be an especially good carrier of the universal fluid. When intentions of healing are focused on it by spirits and mediums of good moral standing, the water becomes a vehicle for those energies into the physical body. The mechanism parallels the pass but operates through the digestive system rather than direct perispirit contact.

Trincado's approach was more reserved on fluidified water than mainstream Brazilian Spiritism — consistent with his generally more rationalist, less ceremony-oriented position. EMECU sessions emphasize the rational study of doctrine and the magnetic pass over the distribution of water, which Trincado associated with the "faith healing" tendency he rejected in other Spiritist currents.

Disobsession — Spirit-Release Therapy — Step-by-Step

The Practice of Freeing Individuals from Negative Spiritual Influence

Disobsession (desobsessão in Brazilian Portuguese, desposesión in Spanish) is the Spiritist practice of addressing negative spiritual influence — what religious traditions might call obsession, oppression, or possession. In Spiritism it is understood not as demonic invasion but as the persistent influence of inferior spirits who, for reasons rooted in past-life relationships or energetic affinities, are disturbing the harmony of an incarnate person.

Critically, disobsession in Spiritism is not exorcism. There is no battle, no command, no forcible removal. The approach is compassionate dialogue and moral education — for the obsessing spirit as much as for the obsessed person. Both need help; neither is an enemy.

Step 1 — Opening Prayer and Vibratory Harmonization

The session opens with collective prayer specifically invoking protection and the presence of highly evolved spirits capable of assisting with the work. The vibratory quality of the group is deliberately elevated before the obsessing spirit is invited to communicate.

Step 2 — Identification of the Situation

The person seeking help (or their representative, since the person does not always need to be present) describes the symptoms: disturbances of sleep, thought, emotion, or physical health; persistent negative thoughts or impulses; sensations of presence. A medium with experience in this work is assigned to receive the obsessing spirit.

Step 3 — The Obsessing Spirit Communicates

The assigned medium enters trance or semi-trance and the obsessing spirit is invited to communicate through them. The spirit may express confusion, anger, grief, a sense of having been wronged (often in a past life by the current obsessed person), or simply ignorance of its own condition — including, in some cases, ignorance that it is dead.

Step 4 — Compassionate Dialogue

A "doctrinator" — an experienced Spiritist worker skilled in this specific work — engages the obsessing spirit in conversation. The tone is of empathy and patient explanation, never confrontation or command. The goal is to help the spirit understand: that its behavior harms its own spiritual progress; that the feelings driving its attachment (resentment, grief, obsessive love) are themselves the symptoms of its evolutionary state; and that forgiveness — of both the person it is disturbing and itself — is the path toward its own liberation.

Step 5 — The Teaching and the Release

Advanced spirit benefactors work alongside the doctrinator, providing comfort and moral instruction to the obsessing spirit. If the spirit is receptive, it agrees to withdraw and is assisted by its spirit guides toward a more elevated state. This process may take one session or many sessions — it is not complete until the spirit genuinely understands and chooses differently.

Step 6 — Work with the Obsessed Person

The person who has been disturbed receives passes, moral counsel, and doctrinal instruction. The long-term solution always involves the person's own moral development — because the energetic compatibility that allowed the obsession to occur must be changed from within. You cannot simply remove an inferior spirit from someone who continues to maintain the same energetic field that attracted it.

Step 7 — Closing Prayer and Follow-Up

The session closes with prayer of gratitude and protection. Follow-up sessions are typically scheduled, since disobsession rarely resolves in a single meeting. The person is encouraged to attend regular Spiritist sessions and to engage in active moral self-examination.

Charity Work

The Supreme Practical Expression of Spiritist Doctrine

"Outside of charity there is no salvation." This axiom from The Gospel According to Spiritism is not a metaphor. Kardec and every significant subsequent Spiritist teacher have insisted that doctrinal study and mediumistic practice without charitable action are incomplete — that Spiritism without charity is philosophy without practice.

Brazilian Spiritism built an extraordinary network of charitable institutions over the course of the 20th century: Spiritist hospitals (including psychiatric institutions that integrate conventional medicine with disobsession and passes), schools, daycare centers, food programs, and soup kitchens. The International Spiritist Medical Association coordinates medical and healing work across the international Spiritist community. All of this charitable work is understood as an expression of the moral law — the spirit that acts with love toward others is practicing, in the most concrete terms possible, the doctrine it has studied.

Trincado's communal colonies were his version of this practical expression — taken to its logical conclusion. If all human beings are evolving spirits of equal origin and equal dignity, then the social structures that create poverty, inequality, and preventable suffering are not merely political failures but spiritual ones, and the Spiritist who does not engage with them has not understood the doctrine.

Study Groups and Doctrinal Practice

The Spiritist and Trincadista Approach to Doctrinal Learning

Both Kardecist Spiritism and Trincado's EMECU place extraordinary emphasis on the systematic study of doctrine. This is not peripheral — it is the foundation. Spiritism holds that "unshakeable faith is only that which can meet reason face to face in every era of humanity." A person who practices Spiritism without understanding its principles is, by Spiritism's own standards, not yet practicing Spiritism.

In Brazilian Spiritism, the FEB (Brazilian Spiritist Federation) formalized this through the ESDE — Estudo Sistematizado da Doutrina Espírita (Systematic Study of the Spiritist Doctrine, launched 1984) — a graded curriculum for adults, paralleled by children's and youth study groups that teach moral values through Spiritist principles. In EMECU, the school's structure is itself the organizing principle: branches are called cátedras (academic chairs), meetings are called aulas (classes), and progression through the doctrine is explicitly pedagogical.

The EMECU's Guatemalan branch articulates the school's method: "la escuela expone, no impone" — the school presents, it does not impose. Students engage with the material through reason, ask questions, test the teachings against their own observation and experience, and

reach their own conclusions. This is the anti-dogmatic, anti-authoritarian approach that distinguishes Trincado's school from religious institutions: no one is asked to believe because they were told to. They are asked to think.

The Haligric Lens

Spiritism in the Haligricity Framework

Spiritism earns its place in the Haligricity library not merely as an interesting tradition from Latin America but as one of the most directly aligned traditions with the framework's foundational principles. The alignment is not superficial — it is structural, running through the moral philosophy, the cosmological model, the understanding of good and evil, and the role of the individual in their own spiritual development.

The Anti-Fear, Anti-Reward Moral Philosophy

The Haligric framework holds that morality pursued out of fear or hope for external reward is not genuine morality — it is compliance under duress. Spiritism's moral architecture is built on exactly this understanding. The consequences of action are self-generated through the law of cause and effect, not imposed by an external judge. The Creator corrects, does not punish. Goodness is pursued for one's own spiritual advancement, not because God is watching. This is the most direct and complete alignment between any tradition in the library and the Haligric anti-fear, anti-reward moral principle.

Universal Laws as the Operating System of Reality

Haligricity recognizes the universal laws — including the Law of Vibration, the Law of Correspondence, the Law of Cause and Effect — as the actual operating system of reality. Spiritism's entire structure rests on the same recognition: natural law governs both the physical and moral dimensions of existence with the same consistency. What Spiritism adds is the temporal scale — these laws operate across multiple lifetimes and multiple worlds, not just within a single human life. The long game of cause and effect is the entire arc of the spirit's evolution.

The Universe Is Never External — All Is Self

Haligricity holds that the universe is never external — all is self, all is the same consciousness experiencing itself from different vantage points. Trincado's monism — "All is Spiritual Magnetism. The Law is one. The Substance is one" — is the most direct statement of this principle within the Spiritist tradition. The material and spiritual planes are not separate domains; they are the same substance at different degrees of refinement. The spirit and the universe it inhabits are not separate; they are the same energy organized in different ways. What Trincado called "the Universe in solidarity" is the energetic statement of the non-dual principle.

The Tetralty in Spiritist Practice

The Haligric Tetralty — Feel, Think, Speak, Do — finds its expression in Spiritist practice in a particularly integrated form. Feeling is addressed through the pass, the Spiritist session, and the recognition of the emotional dimension of spiritual influence and development. Thinking is

addressed through the relentless emphasis on doctrinal study and rational understanding — Spiritism insists that you must understand what you practice. Speaking is the domain of mediumship and prayer — the moral quality of what one says (and thinks, since thought is a force in Spiritism) determines the quality of one's spiritual environment. Doing is charity — the supreme practical expression that transforms doctrinal knowledge into lived reality.

The Resonance with Trincado's Personal Legacy

The Haligrity library acknowledges the personal dimension of this entry. The Trincado books in this family collection are not merely historical artifacts — they are the material form of a grandfather's lifetime of practice and teaching. A tradition passed from grandfather to grandchild through decades of conversation about the nature of the soul, the mechanics of karma, the logic of reincarnation, and the sufficiency of love as a governing principle is a tradition that has proven its living vitality. The books deserve to be preserved, transcribed, and made available — not because they are curiosities but because they contain a coherent and rigorous account of how the moral universe actually works.

To be born, to die, to be reborn again, and to progress unceasingly — such is the law. The consequences of every action return to their source. The Creator corrects, does not punish. Do good for the sake of your own evolution, not for fear of punishment or hope of reward. This is not a religious teaching. It is the description of how reality functions. Your grandfather knew this. Now it is written down. Grand Rising.

Controversies and Scientific Engagement

How Spiritism Engages with Science, the Church, and Its Own Boundaries

Spiritism as "Science, Philosophy, and Religion"

Kardec described Spiritism as having a "triple character": it is a science of observation (investigating spirit phenomena through systematic method), a philosophical doctrine (drawing moral and metaphysical conclusions from those observations), and a religion (insofar as it addresses the soul's relationship with God and future life). Whether Spiritism is properly a "religion" remains internally debated — a 1925 Paris congress proposed removing the religious designation. Most contemporary Spiritist federations, particularly in Brazil, maintain all three aspects; Trincado's school explicitly rejects the religious aspect entirely.

Scientific Investigation

Spiritism has engaged with psychical research from its earliest days — Kardec himself corresponded with early parapsychologists, and figures like Camille Flammarion, Charles Richet, and in Brazil Hernani Guimarães Andrade conducted investigations of mediumistic phenomena. Brazilian researchers have conducted clinical studies on passes and "Spiritist therapy" for depression and anxiety, with results that remain contested in mainstream scientific literature. Spiritism does not claim that spirit phenomena violate natural law — it claims they operate through natural laws not yet fully understood.

Relationship with Catholicism

The relationship between Spiritism and the Catholic Church has been historically hostile. The Church has consistently condemned Spiritism as heretical and dangerous; Brazil's 1890 Penal Code criminalized it; persecution occurred under Vargas. In Latin America specifically, the Church's opposition to Spiritism was intensified by Spiritism's anti-clerical positions and its direct challenge to Catholic doctrines of heaven, hell, purgatory, and the immortality of the soul as Catholic theology defines it. Trincado welcomed and amplified this conflict, seeing institutional religion as the primary mechanism for maintaining the fear-and-reward moral system he rejected.

Distinction from Afro-Brazilian Traditions

Kardecist Spiritism is doctrinally and socially distinct from Umbanda and Candomblé, though all three involve spirit communication. Candomblé centers on orixá worship, spirit possession, and ritual offerings from West African sacred tradition. Umbanda (founded by medium Zélio Fernandino de Moraes in 1908) blends Spiritism, Catholicism, Amerindian tradition, and African spiritual elements — including possession by orixás and exus that Kardecism rejects. Some historical conflation occurred during Brazil's persecution of all such practices, but the doctrines are fundamentally different. These traditions are covered in their own dedicated documents in the Haligrlicity library.

Controversies Around Trincado

Mainstream Kardecists dispute Trincado's legitimacy on the grounds that his works are personal doctrine, not the result of the rigorous multi-medium corroboration that Kardec required for inclusion in the Codification. His radical politics and messianic elements (including prophecies of a geological cataclysm ending the current world cycle) drew criticism both from within the Spiritist movement and from the political authorities of his era in Argentina. The 1938 rupture in Mexico reflects the organizational tensions that arise in any movement built around a charismatic founder's personal authority. None of this diminishes the philosophical quality of his core teachings or the depth of commitment they have inspired in successive generations of practitioners.

The tradition that began in a Parisian apartment where a French educator sat at a table asking systematic questions and receiving answers no one could explain — and that continued in a Buenos Aires working-class community where a Spanish electrician built a school without a building and a doctrine without a church — is alive. It was alive in a grandfather who taught it to a grandchild over a lifetime of conversation. It is alive in the books that survive him. It is alive here. Grand Rising.